

SIM — Sustainability Integrity Module

Parent Standard: Ethical Layer Standard

Protocol: EVIP® — Ethical Virtual Integrity Protocol

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Sustainability Integrity

Type: Ethical Validity Module

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Status: Canonical · Open Module

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Compatibility: OOF® Methodology OS™ · **Ethical Layer Standard** · EVIP® · **INTEGROS®** · TVL® · **UCL™**

Authority: OOF®

Protection: MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (**UCL™**)

Canonical Definition

Sustainability Integrity Module defines the structural conditions under which a methodology, system, device, hardware structure, AI environment, autonomous process, or deployment pathway preserves sustainability as a condition of ethical validity.

A system satisfies SIM only if:

- sustainability is treated as a structural condition, not as optional messaging
- destructive environmental or resource logic is not accepted as a normal operating condition
- long-term viability is not sacrificed for short-term gain
- operational design does not depend on irresponsible depletion, contamination, or structurally unsustainable expansion
- system validity is denied where sustainability breakdown remains structurally tolerated

A system that depends on structurally unsustainable conditions does not satisfy SIM.

Module Function

SIM defines the sustainability boundary of ethical validity.

It ensures that no methodology, system, or technology may pass ethical layer conditions if its operation, scale, or deployment logic depends on structurally irresponsible ecological, material, or long-term resource conditions.

The module applies wherever systems influence environmental continuity, material use, operational lifecycle, or long-term systemic sustainability.

Minimum Implementation Framework (MIF)

Step 1 — Define Sustainability Exposure

The organization must define where the system affects ecological, material, or long-term operational sustainability.

Minimum requirement:

- sustainability impact boundaries are identifiable
 - direct and indirect sustainability exposure is recognized
 - ecological and material effects are not treated as undefined externalities
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Step 2 — Define Unsustainable Pathways

The organization must identify where structural unsustainability may occur.

Minimum requirement:

- destructive dependencies are explicitly mapped
 - depletion, contamination, waste, or unsustainable scale pathways are visible
 - silent tolerance of unsustainable operation is excluded
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Step 3 — Define Sustainability Conditions

The system must define the conditions under which sustainability remains preserved.

Minimum requirement:

- sustainability conditions are explicit
 - long-term viability is considered before reliance
 - sustainability is not reduced to narrative or post-failure correction only
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Step 4 — Define Restriction and Escalation Conditions

The system must define when operation, scale, or deployment must be restricted due to unsustainable conditions.

Minimum requirement:

- restriction conditions are explicit
 - escalation logic exists for sustainability breakdown
 - continued operation under structurally unsustainable conditions is not treated as valid
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Step 5 — Preserve Long-Term Integrity

The system must not privilege immediate efficiency, profit, or scale over long-term sustainability integrity.

Minimum requirement:

- short-term gain does not override sustainability conditions
- growth does not justify structural depletion or destruction
- system legitimacy remains subordinate to sustainable continuity

Step 6 — Restrict Invalid Deployment

The system must not be treated as ethically valid if unsustainable conditions remain structurally present and ungoverned.

Minimum requirement:

- invalid sustainability conditions are identifiable
- unresolved destructive pathways block ethical passage
- performance alone does not restore sustainability validity

Use Case 1 — Industrial Production System

Scenario

A production system is efficient, scalable, and commercially viable, but its operational logic depends on resource waste, environmentally destructive inputs, or structurally unsustainable process conditions.

Application

SIM is used to ensure:

- sustainability exposure is defined
- destructive pathways are identified
- restriction conditions exist
- scale does not override sustainability validity

Result

The organization gains a stronger ethical boundary preventing an operationally successful system from being treated as valid when its long-term logic remains structurally unsustainable.

Use Case 2 — AI and Infrastructure Expansion

Scenario

An AI-driven infrastructure expands rapidly through increasing computation, hardware usage, energy demand, and operational dependency without clear sustainability boundaries.

Application

SIM is used to ensure:

- sustainability impacts are mapped
 - unsustainable growth logic is identified
 - restriction and escalation conditions exist
 - capability expansion does not override sustainability integrity
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Result

The organization gains a stronger ethical passage condition preventing future technology growth from being treated as valid solely because it is powerful, scalable, or profitable.

Canonical Closing Statement

If sustainability breakdown remains structurally tolerated, ethical validity has not been achieved.

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Canonical Source

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